Pre-launch checklist

PRELAUNCH-CHECKLIST.MD · SEPTEMBER 9, 2026

Everything on this site that is still a placeholder, plus the client material that has arrived but is not yet wired in. Grep for `TODO:CLIENT` to find items in place.

The site must not go live with any box below unticked.

BLOCKERS

- [ ] **Remove the `noindex` header.** `netlify.toml` ends with a PRE-LAUNCH ONLY block sending `X-Robots-Tag: noindex, nofollow` on every page, so the draft stays out of Google while the client reviews it. **Delete that block before launch** — left in, the finished site never appears in search results.

- [ ] **The site uses one colour outside the official palette.** The italic emphasis in every headline is the pre-rebrand gold `#C8A24A`, added on the client's explicit instruction because Soft Cream disappears on White and on the Soft Cream band. The guidelines say "*Do not use colors that are not included in the brand's official palette for brand representation.*" Measured: **3.7:1 on Deep Blue** (passes AA for large text), **2.4:1 on White** and **2.0:1 on Soft Cream** (both below the 3:1 threshold). Get this signed off, or switch `--color-gold` to `#a9822f`, which clears 3:1 on White and still reads as the same gold. One-line change in `src/input.css`.

- [ ] **Brand font files.** The guidelines specify **Dream Avenue** (headers) and **ITC Avant Garde** (body, Regular + Bold). Neither was in the brand bundle and both are licensed commercial faces. The site currently ships **Playfair Display** and **Poppins** as documented stand-ins, so it is **not yet strictly compliant on typography.** Fix: obtain the licensed webfonts, drop the `.woff2` files into `public/assets/fonts/`, and update the two `@font-face` blocks and the `--font-display` / `--font-sans` tokens in `src/input.css`.

- [ ] **Gallery does not exist.** It is linked from the nav, the footer and the home page's "See the full gallery" button, so **those links are 404s.** About Us, FAQs, the Enquiry Form and Thank You are built. The Process and Testimonials are no longer pages: both nav items are now fragment links to sections of the home page (`/#process`, `/#testimonials`). The full five-step process also lives on `/about`.

- [ ] **Confirm the enquiry form after the first deploy.** Netlify only registers a form when it finds it in the deployed HTML, so it cannot be tested locally. After the first deploy: submit the form once, confirm the submission appears under **Site configuration → Forms**, confirm the couple lands on `/thank-you`, and set up the email notification so an enquiry is not sitting unread in the Netlify dashboard.

- [ ] **Mechanical corrections were made to the testimonials.** Words unchanged; confirm the client is happy with these: - Hema Gowri: `photos-they captured feelings` -> em dash - Shanmuga Raja: `Exceeded all expectations! possesses an innate talent` -> capital P after the full stop - Trailing full stops after the names dropped (`- Thiviia.` -> `Thiviia`) - Straight quotes and `...` set as typographic apostrophes and ellipses

- [ ] **Niveditha's review is a raw paste.** It runs to roughly 200 words of clauses joined by ellipses, against 50-100 for the others, and is nearly twice the height of any other card. Shipped in full and unedited; worth asking whether they want it tightened.

- [ ] **A typo in the FAQ copy was corrected.** Q2 read "The invßestment can depend on..."; shipped as "investment". Worth confirming with the client that no other stray characters survived their draft.
- [ ] `/faq` **publishes a price.** Q2 states "The starting investment price is 70,000 INR per day." Confirm the client is happy for that figure to be public before launch, and that it is current.
- [ ] **Two of the client's process steps have nearly the same name.** Step 03 is "*You're Booked*" and step 04 is "*You're On Board*", but step 03's own text also ends "you're officially on board". Reproduced verbatim on `/about`; worth asking the client whether 04 should be renamed (something like "*On the Day*").

Client material received but not yet used

The bundle at `TMC Website Bundle – Shared by Narayan/` contains real content that is still sitting behind Lorem Ipsum on the site:

- [x] ~~`Documents/About Us for TMC Website.docx`~~ — **done.** The full essay and all five process steps are live on `/about`, verbatim.
- [x] ~~`Documents/FAQ for TMC.docx`~~ — **done.** All twelve questions and answers are live on `/faq`, verbatim.
- [x] ~~`Documents/Testimonials for TMC.docx`~~ — **done.** All nine reviews are live on the home page via `partials/testimonials.html`, ready to include on each gallery page too.
- [x] ~~`Documents/Enquiry Form for TMC.docx`~~ — **done.** All eleven questions are live on `/contact`, wired to Netlify Forms.
- [ ] **120 real photographs** in `Test Assets – Shared by Narayan/` (`Highres/` and `Lowres/`). Every image on the site is still Western stock.

Copy that can be lifted straight from the brand guidelines PDF:

- [x] ~~**Philosophy** (p2)~~ — live on `/about`.
- [x] ~~**The idea behind TMC** (p3)~~ — live on `/about`.
- [x] ~~**Who we are** (p4)~~ — live on `/about`.
- [x] ~~Positioning line: "*A place for memories to endure.*"~~ — closes `/about`.

Copy that is still ours, not the client's, and needs their approval:

- [ ] `/about` — the Our Process section heading ("Our process, from first message to final delivery"). The five steps under it are theirs.
- [ ] `/faq` — the page headline ("The questions couples ask us most") and the closing section ("Still have a question? / Ask us anything"). Every question and answer is theirs.
- [ ] Testimonials section heading ("In their own words"). The nine reviews are theirs.
- [ ] `/index` — the hero headline, all Selected Work captions and the three-step process teaser. Still Lorem Ipsum in places. (The placeholder testimonial is gone — replaced by the client's real reviews.)
- [ ] `partials/footer.html` — the footer blurb is still Lorem Ipsum.

Imagery

The guidelines are specific: "*Quietly cinematic, intimate, and timeless. Natural light, soft shadows, muted earthy tones, and subtle film-like grain… observed rather than staged.*" The reference images are South Indian Tamil weddings — garlands, silks, temple settings.

- [ ] **All current imagery is Western stock and does not match this.** Replace with the client's own work throughout: `public/assets/img/hero/` (6), `public/assets/img/gallery/` (15 tiles), `public/assets/img/work/` (7), `public/assets/img/about/` (2).
- [ ] Re-check each gallery tile's `--focal` crop centre after swapping, or square-cropping will cut off faces.
- [ ] Update every `alt` attribute to describe the real photograph.
- [ ] Re-check the hero tint after the swap. `tintOpacity` and `veilOpacity` in `preferences.js` were eased to 0.22 / 0.16 because Deep Blue is a mid-tone and colourises rather than darkens; the right values depend on the real photographs.
- [ ] The About spread renders its two images black & white. Confirm that is wanted, or remove the `filter` on `.about__figure img`.

Copy

- [ ] Hero lede, About body and signature, four "selected work" captions, three process steps, testimonial quote, closing CTA, footer positioning line
- [ ] Photographer's name — currently "Placeholder Name, Founder"
- [ ] Statistics "200+ / 12 / 9" are invented

Still to do

- [ ] **Open Graph image** — still points at a stock hero photo
- [ ] **Instagram** and other social links — currently `href="#"`
- [ ] Real `404.html`
- [ ] Contact form — Netlify Forms needs `data-netlify="true"`, a hidden `form-name` input, a honeypot, and a `thank-you.html`
- [ ] Confirm Netlify's current form-submission limit; spam counts toward it
- [ ] Full footer (the current one is provisional)

Done

- [x] Official four-colour palette applied site-wide; no non-palette colour remains in the stylesheet
- [x] Official logo artwork in header and footer; tagline lockup in the footer
- [x] Favicon and touch icon generated from the TMC monogram on Deep Blue
- [x] Real contact details: thememoryconservatory@gmail.com, +91 84385 33169, #28 Duraiswamy Pillai St, West Tambaram, Chennai
- [x] WhatsApp button wired to the real number

- [x] Contrast audited — 18/18 text styles pass WCAG AA